

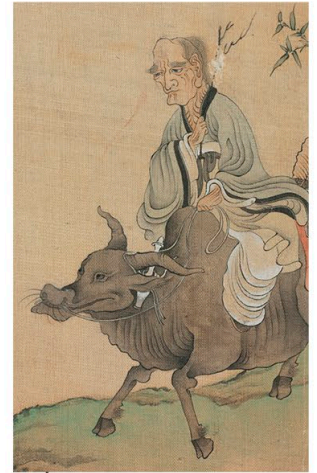


△ Emperor Jimmu and the rising sun

7th century BCE CHINA'S HUNDRED SCHOOLS OF THOUGHT

Philosophy flourished in the Eastern Zhou period in China.

The diverse systems that emerged became known as the Hundred Schools of Thought, and included such thinkers as Laozi (founder of Daoism), Kong Fuzi (or Confucius, founder of Confucianism), Mozi (Mohism), and Han Feizi (Legalism).



△ Laozi riding an ox

621 BCE The so-called “Age of Tyrants” begins in many Greek city-states

620–600 BCE True coins are used as currency for the first time in Lydia (modern Turkey)

601 BCE

620 BCE Draco sets out the first law code in Athens (hence “draconian”)

612 BCE The collapse of the Neo-Assyrian Empire is triggered by the destruction of Nineveh by rebelling Babylonians and Medes



▽ Stela of Ashurbanipal

The library of Ashurbanipal contained texts on more than 30,000 clay tablets

668 BCE

ASHURBANIPAL BECOMES ASSYRIAN EMPEROR

Sometimes proclaimed as the “last great king of Assyria”, Ashurbanipal came to power when the Assyrian Empire was at its height. During his reign, he established Nineveh as the cultural, political, and commercial centre of the empire, with an extensive library housing texts such as the *Epic of Gilgamesh*, and buildings lavishly decorated with statues and bas-reliefs.